



RCCG OCEANIA

Relationships

CHOOSING A SPOUSE WITH LOVE AND WISDOM

AT A GLANCE

BIG IDEA

Marriage is more than just a feeling; it's a commitment that requires careful consideration of who you marry. By understanding the different types of love and ensuring a strong spiritual foundation, you can build a lasting relationship. Discover how friendship and commitment play crucial roles in choosing the right partner.

PRIMARY PASSAGES

1 Corinthians 13:4-7

Ephesians 5:25-33

Proverbs 18:22

1 Peter 3:7

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Choosing the right spouse is crucial for a successful marriage.
- Love in marriage is a commitment, not just a feeling.
- Friendship is a vital component of a lasting relationship.
- A strong spiritual foundation is essential in marriage.
- Physical attraction should not be the primary basis for marriage.

INTRODUCTION

In the journey of life, choosing a spouse is one of the most significant decisions one can make. This decision lays the groundwork for a successful marriage, which is built on commitment, friendship, and spiritual compatibility. By understanding the different dimensions of love and the importance of a shared spiritual foundation, individuals can make wise choices that lead to fulfilling relationships.

SCRIPTURE READING

- **1 Corinthians 13:4-7** — This passage defines love as patient and kind, emphasizing commitment over feelings.
- **Ephesians 5:25-33** — Highlights the importance of love and sacrifice in marriage, reflecting Christ's love for the church.
- **Proverbs 18:22** — Speaks to the blessing of finding a good spouse, underscoring the importance of choice.
- **1 Peter 3:7** — Encourages understanding and respect in marriage, essential for a strong partnership.

KEY POINTS

1. **THE IMPORTANCE OF CHOOSING WISELY** — The secret to a successful marriage lies in the choice of spouse. A wrong choice can lead to lifelong challenges, while the right choice sets the foundation for a fulfilling relationship. Proverbs 18:22 reminds us of the blessing that comes with finding a good spouse. This decision should be made with careful consideration, prayer, and wisdom.

- Reflect on the qualities you value in a spouse.
- Seek counsel from trusted mentors or spiritual leaders.
- Pray for wisdom and discernment in your decision-making.
- Consider the long-term implications of your choice.

Scripture: Proverbs 18:22

2. **UNDERSTANDING LOVE AS COMMITMENT** — Love in marriage should be seen as a commitment rather than a fleeting feeling. This perspective helps couples navigate challenges with resilience. 1 Corinthians 13:4-7 describes love as patient and kind, highlighting the enduring nature of true love. By embracing love as a commitment, couples can build a strong foundation for their marriage.

- Discuss with your partner what commitment means to both of you.
- Identify ways to demonstrate love through actions, not just words.
- Practice patience and kindness in your daily interactions.
- Commit to resolving conflicts with love and understanding.

Scripture: 1 Corinthians 13:4-7

3. **FRIENDSHIP AS THE BEDROCK OF MARRIAGE** — Marrying your friend ensures a deeper connection and mutual understanding, which are crucial for a lasting relationship. Friendship in marriage fosters open communication and shared experiences. 1 Peter 3:7 encourages couples to live with understanding and respect, which are hallmarks of true friendship.

- Spend quality time together to strengthen your friendship.
- Engage in activities that you both enjoy.
- Communicate openly and honestly with each other.
- Support each other's personal growth and interests.

Scripture: 1 Peter 3:7

KEY POINTS (CONT.)

4. **BUILDING A SPIRITUAL FOUNDATION** — A shared spiritual foundation provides strength and guidance, helping couples withstand life's pressures and grow together. Ephesians 5:25-33 illustrates the sacrificial love that should characterize a marriage, mirroring Christ's love for the church. A strong spiritual connection can guide couples through challenges and deepen their bond.

- Pray together regularly to strengthen your spiritual bond.
- Attend worship services or spiritual gatherings as a couple.
- Discuss your spiritual beliefs and values with each other.
- Encourage each other in personal spiritual growth.

Scripture: Ephesians 5:25-33

GROUP DISCUSSION

Tip: Use these questions to guide the group from seeing → understanding → applying.

OBSERVATION

- What qualities does Proverbs 18:22 highlight as important in choosing a spouse?
- How does 1 Corinthians 13:4-7 define love?
- What does Ephesians 5:25-33 say about the role of love and sacrifice in marriage?
- According to 1 Peter 3:7, what are key elements of a strong partnership?

INTERPRETATION

- Why is choosing the right spouse considered crucial for a successful marriage?
- How can viewing love as a commitment change the dynamics of a relationship?
- In what ways does friendship contribute to the longevity of a marriage?
- How does a shared spiritual foundation impact a marriage?

APPLICATION

- What steps can you take to ensure you are choosing a spouse wisely?
- How can you cultivate a deeper friendship with your partner?
- What are practical ways to demonstrate commitment in your relationship?
- How can you and your partner build a stronger spiritual foundation together?

PRAYER FOCUS

- Pray for wisdom and discernment in choosing a life partner.
- Ask for guidance in building a marriage based on commitment and friendship.
- Seek strength to develop a shared spiritual foundation with your spouse.
- Pray for patience and kindness to be evident in your relationship.

NEXT STEP

Reflect on the qualities you value in a spouse and seek guidance through prayer and counsel.

CONCLUSION

Choosing a spouse with love and wisdom is a vital step towards a successful and fulfilling marriage. By understanding the importance of commitment, friendship, and a shared spiritual foundation, individuals can make informed decisions that lead to lasting relationships. Embrace these principles and apply them in your journey towards finding and nurturing a loving partnership.